

TIME TRAVEL

WE TRAVERSE A FEW THOUSAND KILOMETRES IN THE MARUTI SUZUKI GRAND VITARA, VISITING INDUS VALLEY CIVILISATION EXCAVATION SITES TO GET A SENSE OF THE SIGNIFICANCE OF THE LATEST DISCOVERIES IN ANCIENT ARCHAEOLOGY

BY DHRUV SAXENA

Drive three hours to travel 6,000 years back in time. This statement by Balram Kumar, an archaeologist closely associated with the excavation at Rakhigarhi—touted as the largest Harappan Civilisation archaeological site—perfectly encapsulates the idea behind our journey covering thousands of kilometres, visiting excavation sites spread across Haryana, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh. From Baror, not too far from the Indo-Pak border in Rajasthan, to Sanauli in Uttar Pradesh, to Rakhigarhi in Haryana and eventually to the National Museum in Delhi, the journey offered an insight into the history, technological advancements and evolution of the Harappans and the culture's influence on life as we know.



PAST MATTERS National Museum's Harappan Civilisation exhibit features artefacts that have been excavated from these sites



To truly appreciate the historical significance of these sites, one has to look past what meets the eye and delve deep into published accounts of their excavation and visit museums such as the one in Kalibangan or even the Nation Museum that showcase what was found at these sites right from the tools used to the jewellery worn and even mock-ups of traditional Harappan burial sites.

In many ways, the journey was akin to time travel with the Maruti Suzuki Grand Vitara assuming the role of our time machine and an impressive one at that. It proved to be efficient, comfortable and a very capable road-trip companion, qualities that help make it such an attractive proposition. Good roads, smooth highways and off-road trails, the Maruti Suzuki Grand Vitara took it all in its stride and made the drive that much more enriching. ■